



PROGRESS REPORT

Namibia: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-10.

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A National Digital Strategy was published in August 2025 and a ministry strategic plan and ICT policy launched in January 2026, with neither text held. The digital strategy is in force and the national data centre it calls for was still at concept-note stage a month after publication; the document itself is not held and two sources give its period differently (strategy, readiness). The ministry's strategic plan and national ICT policy were launched at Opuwo in January 2026, prioritising affordable broadband and mobile coverage in rural and underserved areas, cybersecurity, data protection and electronic government, and naming high data costs, limited infrastructure and unequal access as the barriers; neither document text is held (plan).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	A National Digital Strategy was launched in August 2025 and the ICT ministry's five-year plan in January 2026. The minister launched the National Digital Strategy together with a National Emergency Telecommunications Plan on 5 August 2025, as the framework for the country's digital transformation (launch). The ministry's own strategic plan for 2025 to 2030 was launched regionally at Opuwo in January 2026, its priorities affordable broadband and mobile coverage in rural and underserved areas, cybersecurity, data protection and electronic government (plan). The national data centre the digital strategy calls for was still at concept-note stage a month after the strategy launched, and is now a flagship project inside a N\$639.2 million ICT budget for 2026/27 (budget). Two strategies and a plan in eighteen months; what the base does not hold is a delivery measure against any of them.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	The National Broadband Policy of 2020 is the standing instrument, and the regulator consulted in 2025 on raising the minimum broadband speed. The policy was gazetted in August 2020 under the Communications Act and no revision or successor is held (policy). The regulator consulted on a proposed ministerial policy directive raising the minimum broadband speed, with the commenting period extended to 29 August 2025; no directive, speed figure or commencement has followed (consultation). Delivery runs through the universal service fund: the state fixed operator won a N\$9,796,650 subsidy in April 2026 to deploy infrastructure at sites in underserved rural areas (agreement). The standing target is full telecommunications coverage by 2030, unchanged and with no later official coverage figure held.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	No government cloud strategy is held. Cabinet directed work on a national data centre in September 2025, now funded as a flagship for 2026/27. Cabinet issued directives in September 2025 instructing the ICT ministry and the Office of the Prime Minister to finalise a concept note and project proposal for a national data centre (directives). A year on it is one of the ministry's flagship projects for 2026/27 inside a N\$639.2 million budget, with no site, capacity, cost or completion date published (budget). The one binding hosting rule on the base is sectoral: the central bank's cloud computing determination requires banking institutions to ensure their cloud providers meet data protection law including data residency requirements (determination). Two commercial facilities operate, one run by an operator and one by an aerospace company. Nothing sets a rule for where government data sits.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	The spatial data infrastructure policy of 2015 is the one gazetted cross-government sharing framework; a general interoperability framework drafted in 2016 was never gazetted. The spatial data policy was gazetted in March 2015 as the framework for sharing spatial data across government (policy). For everything else, a government expression of interest carries the fullest dated account: an interoperability framework drafted by the Office of the Prime Minister's public service information technology management department in 2016, modelled on Estonia's data-exchange layer, with no gazetted framework, adoption date or implementing platform since (timeline). Where a roadmap does exist it is in payments: the central bank's vision and strategy for 2026 to 2030 sets open banking, the quick-response standard and application-programming-interface interoperability as central themes (vision), operationalised for open banking by a guidance note in January 2026 (guidance). The sector with a roadmap is the sector with a regulator that writes them.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A national artificial-intelligence strategy is in development through the research council working group, guided by a completed readiness assessment. Consultations began under the council's working group and its technical advisory committees; no draft is published, and the ministry states the strategy is sequenced ahead of legislation (strategy, framework, coordination). The working group is a multi-stakeholder platform with science, data and skills committees and runs the national strategy process (group). A readiness assessment was completed by the council with the education ministry and an international body, and its findings were restated by the authors in February 2026; the report itself is not held (assessment).	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	No localisation policy is held. The cloud determination obliges banks to check their providers against residency requirements, and binds nobody else. The central bank's determination requires banking institutions to ensure cloud service providers adhere to data protection law including data residency requirements and privacy standards (determination). It binds banks, not government, and the capture is truncated. The statute that would carry a national rule does not exist: the Data Protection Bill was promised for tabling in September 2025 and was described in January 2026 as under final polishing (tabling, polishing). The national data centre that would give government somewhere domestic to host is funded and unbuilt (budget). A country with no data protection Act has no instrument in which a residency rule could sit.	NO CHANGE one sectoral residency clause and no national rule

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	The Data Protection Bill was promised for tabling in September 2025 and was still in final polishing in January 2026; the statistics agency's 2014 policy is the operative instrument. The ministry said in August 2025 it would table the Bill that September (tabling); in January 2026 the minister described the data protection and cybercrime bills as under final polishing (polishing). It is not tabled and no data-protection statute is in force. What is operative is narrower: the statistics agency's own policy of February 2014 on how it collects, processes and disseminates data (policy), and five national statistics system standards issued in September 2025 covering quality, metadata, inclusion, presentation and dissemination (standards). The cost of the gap is on the record: after a breach at the students' financial assistance fund in October 2025 the incident response team's head called for urgent finalisation of the law (breach). Data governance here is a statistics-agency practice, not a national policy.	STALLED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	No open data policy exists. The Access to Information Act is gazetted and uncommenced, and applications for the Information Commissioner opened in February 2026. The Act is gazetted and not commenced — section 86 leaves commencement to the Minister and no commencement notice is held — but the National Assembly invited applications in February 2026 for the Information Commissioner and Deputy under the appointment regulations (invitation). The closest thing to a publication regime is spatial: the 2015 policy provides for public access and a metadata catalogue (policy), and the statistics agency tendered in October 2025 to redesign the public geoportal that serves it (tender). The agency also runs a microdata catalogue and data portals page. An open data policy would say what every public body must publish. Nothing on this base does, and the statute that would compel disclosure has waited four years for a commencement notice.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Bill has not been tabled about thirteen years after drafting began, and the March 2022 draft remains the last version published for comment. A tabling was announced for September 2025 (announcement, return) and the bill was still in finalisation in August 2026, with no data-protection statute in force (finalisation, concerns). The March 2022 revised draft runs to fifty-nine pages and eight Parts, with the supervisory authority at Part 2 (draft). The 2020 version carries a Part on rights of the data subject, together with Parts on recourse to the judicial authority and on offences and penalties, none of which appears in the 2022 version, where access and correction survive only as controller obligations (2020 version, removal).	STALLED
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	A Cybercrime Bill was named as being finalised in July 2026, with no draft published and no tabling date given. Enforcement has relied on the electronic transactions statute, the communications statute and the penal code; cabinet approved cybercrime proposals in November 2025 (proposals) and the minister named the bill as being finalised alongside the data protection bill in July 2026 (finalisation). The base first names this bill in July 2026, and the national incident response team states in its own report that it cannot fully execute its mandate absent a cybersecurity law.	MOVEMENT marginal

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Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The Civil Registration and Identification Act 13 of 2024 is the statutory basis for a single civil register and a unique identity number, and a gazette notice withdrawing older documents has not issued. The Act was assented in December 2024 as the basis for a single civil register, a unique identity number and identity-data confidentiality, and was read by officials in July 2026 as permitting institutions to accept either the physical card or its digital version, with disclosure conditional on the holder's consent; the commencement date is not established in this base (Act, reading). The notice that will end the validity of pre-independence cards, older documents and current machine-readable cards has not issued, so until it does the September 2026 card is additive rather than replacing anything (notice). 2026-09-07 - the instrument under which the trust chain is accredited is now held: General Notice 953 of 2025 under the Electronic Transactions Act, in force from 15 June 2026, sets the regulator's accreditation regime for security products and services and for the certification service providers that supply them. No accreditation register, fee schedule or list of accredited products is published alongside it.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The Payment System Management Act commenced in August 2023, its licensing determination took effect in January 2026, and government-to-person payments went live in June. The Act commenced on 8 August 2023, and the central bank's PSD-1 determination brought licensing and authorisation of payment service providers into operation on 6 January 2026 (commencement, determination). Under the Act the payments association moved from a management council to a management board during 2025, and a fees and charges determination came into force in December 2025. The first live government-to-person grant payments ran over the national instant payment network on 17 June 2026 through one certified bank (disbursements). An operational and cybersecurity standard for the payment system followed in July 2026. The statute is doing what statutes are for: each determination under it lands as a dated rule.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	The Electronic Transactions Act of 2019 is the enabling statute, and its electronic-signature and accreditation provisions were brought into force in June 2026. The Act of 2019 is the standing statute for electronic transactions and remains the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime (Act). Electronic signature regulations were gazetted in December 2025 and the regulator separately gazetted regulations for accrediting security products, services and their providers; the Act's section 20 and its accreditation chapter were brought into force in June 2026 (signatures, accreditation, commencement). The regulator states it is the national root certification authority, and legally recognised electronic signatures still had no launch on record in July 2026. Trust infrastructure is now legislated. What is not legislated is a duty on public bodies to make their systems talk to each other.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	Artificial-intelligence legislation is announced as following the strategy, and the research council's own authors recorded no governance framework in place. The minister sequenced legislation behind the strategy, and nothing has been drafted or tabled (sequencing, framework). The research council's own authors recorded no artificial-intelligence governance framework in place as at February 2026. A strategy that is itself unpublished cannot yet ground a statute, so both halves of the governance question are pending on the same document.	NO CHANGE announced as following the strategy with nothing drafted or tabled
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	The Electronic Transactions Act 2019 has been in force since March 2021 and covers signatures, consumer protection and contracts but not personal data or cross-border flow. The Act is the interim instrument law enforcement relies on for cybercrime, with the communications statute and the penal code (Act). A regulatory profile records that it does not reach cross-border data flow, data localisation or personal data protection (profile). Company process under the corporate laws reform is routed through it, so it is doing more work than it was written for.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The Statistics Act of 2011 constitutes the agency and the national statistics system, and five standards were issued under it in September 2025. The Act provides for the statistics agency, the national statistics system and the spatial data infrastructure (Act). Five standards were published under its standards mandate in September 2025: statistical quality indicators, statistical metadata, leave no one behind, data and statistics presentation, and data and statistics dissemination (standards). The agency's own strategic plan runs to 2026/27, alongside a strategy for the development of statistics over the same period. The Act is fifteen years old and has not needed amending on this base – which distinguishes it from the data protection statute the same government has been drafting for six.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	The Access to Information Act 8 of 2022 is gazetted and not commenced, and no Information Commissioner has been appointed. Section 86 leaves commencement to a date determined by the minister, no commencement notice is held, and the Act runs to ten Parts and eighty-six sections whose compliance deadlines run from commencement (Act). Appointment machinery for the Commissioner and Deputy was itself gazetted in December 2024, setting five-year selection committee terms and a five-member quorum, made ahead of the Act's own commencement, so the annual report the Act requires cannot yet exist (regulations).	MOVEMENT still not commenced
Data protection	Data protection authority	A Data Protection Supervisory Authority sits at Part 2 of a draft bill that has not been tabled, and no authority exists. The draft's stated objects are establishing the authority with its own powers and duties, obligations on controllers and processors, rights for data subjects, and codes of conduct (draft, earlier version). A civil-society critique of the 2022 consultation argued the sections on the authority's independence need substantial redrafting. Four years on there is no authority, no commencement and no later text.	STALLED

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Data protection	National data protection readiness	The Data Protection Bill was promised for September 2025 and was still in final polishing in January 2026; a breach in October showed what the gap costs. The ministry's budget motivation of May 2025 recorded the Bill still pending discussion in the Cabinet Committee before tabling that financial year (motivation), and in August the ministry said it would table it in September (tabling). In January 2026 the minister described the data protection and cybercrime bills as under final polishing, with consultation on the cybercrime bill opening on 2 February (polishing). In between, the students' financial assistance fund was breached and the national incident response team's head called for urgent finalisation of the law (breach). The last version of the Bill the base holds in full is the revised draft of March 2022. Four years of drafting, one breach and no statute.	STALLED
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Memoranda were signed with Angola and Botswana, and cabinet authorised signature with the Republic of Congo. The Angolan memorandum covers joint events, exchange of expertise and cybersecurity, with no amount or instrument named (Angola). The Botswana memorandum was signed at Kasane in August 2026 between the two ministries with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills; the two sides costed the corridor's remaining 4G gaps at about N\$52 million across thirteen new sites and recorded a completed cross-border fibre link, the first direct one between the operators (Botswana, cooperation). Cabinet approved a memorandum with the Republic of Congo and authorised the minister to sign, with no scope, financing or signature date published (Congo).	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	The regional regulators' legal and policy committee first met at Windhoek in August 2026, and the minister holds a seat on an international artificial-intelligence commission. The committee was constituted and met with artificial-intelligence governance, data governance and protection, digital public infrastructure and regional regulatory harmonisation on its agenda, hosted by the national regulator; no work programme, output or timetable is published (committee). The ICT minister is one of eight Africans on a forty-four member commission, on the convening body's account (seat, declaration).	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A master service agreement with two Angolan counterparts commits 1.0 Tbps of dedicated capacity, and a satellite pilot is running. The agreement was signed in June 2026 by the state fixed operator with two Angolan counterparts, with the Namibian operator as landing party hosting Angolan equipment, covering design, integration, testing, commissioning and handover; it builds on a memorandum and commercial terms agreed in April 2026 (agreement, deals). Initial dedicated transmission capacity on the subsea system is fixed at 1.0 Tbps by that agreement, as stated by the parties, with no delivered figure held (capacity). A pilot commercial agreement between the state fixed operator and Angola's space agency is running, with full commercial launch targeted after the pilot (pilot).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	The government rejected a United States health data and specimen sharing proposal on sovereignty grounds (report). The government rejected a United States proposal to share health data and specimens, citing sovereignty (report), while funding talks ran against a deadline (report). The ICT minister tabled the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection in Parliament for ratification in 2018, and the Union's own status list records the ratification (tabling). The domestic statute the Convention calls for is still a Bill. The two ICT ministries signed a framework at Kasane in August 2026 covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, affordable connectivity and skills development, six months after the two countries' operators signed their own memorandum on cross-border connectivity (government, operators). Regionally the regulator sits on the communications association's legal and policy committee, with artificial intelligence on its agenda. Ratified without a domestic statute is the whole position: nothing on this base governs a transfer of personal data out of the country.	REGRESSED
Standards	National interoperability standards	An interoperability framework was drafted in 2016 on the Estonian model and never gazetted; the standards that exist are in signatures and payments. A government expression of interest carries the fullest dated official account: a framework drafted by the Office of the Prime Minister's public service information technology management department in 2016, modelled on Estonia's data-exchange layer, with no gazetted framework, adoption date or implementing platform since (timeline). Where technical standards have been gazetted they are sectoral. The electronic signature regulations of December 2025 set the rules for signature interoperability (signatures), and a determination of July 2026 sets operational and cybersecurity standards inside the national payment system (payments). A governmental interoperability solution is in service from the Office of the Prime Minister, and an inter-ministry data exchange platform has no record since September 2025. Ten years from a draft framework, the exchange runs and the standard for it is unpublished.	MOVEMENT
Standards	National quality standards	The standards institution has published 235 standards since 2008 and a 2025 strategy targets 1,200 more in three years. The Standards Act of 2005 establishes the institution and its council (Act). A national standardisation strategy launched in October 2025 targets 1,200 new standards over three years, against 235 published since the institution's establishment in 2008 — set beside 1,600 in Botswana, 6,500 in Zambia and more than 10,500 in South Africa (strategy). A package covering chilled seafood, marketing quality, laundry and refrigerating appliances was adopted in June 2026 (adoption). None of the standards named on this base is an information technology standard. The target is five times the output of eighteen years, and no progress figure against it is published.	MOVEMENT
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The regulator states it is the national root certification authority, and the interbank settlement system migrated to the international messaging standard. The regulator states it anchors the digital trust framework and regulates certificate and certification-service providers, a role the ministry had exercised in accrediting electronic-signature providers under the 2019 statute; that places the trust anchor inside the communications regulator rather than a separate cyber agency (authority, accreditation). The interbank settlement system has migrated to the ISO 20022 messaging standard (migration, pact).	MOVEMENT

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Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	The 2022 consultation on the Data Protection Bill drew a coalition submission and an independent critique, and no further consultation is on record. The ministry opened public input in October 2022 with a closing date of 30 November; a civil-society coalition filed a submission on that date and a research institute published the same argument as a public paper in December, arguing the sections on the supervisory authority's independence need substantial redrafting and that the offences and penalties provisions are undeveloped (consultation, submission, critique). No ministry-published list of respondents is held and no further consultation activity is on record since. A separate three-year memorandum between the regulator and the chamber of commerce takes legislative reform as a joint workstream with a business lobby, which the instrument does not address (memorandum).	NO CHANGE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The ICT ministry took the cybercrime bill to three regions in February 2026 and launched its strategic plan regionally in January. The ministry consulted stakeholders from Kavango East, Kavango West and Zambezi on the proposed cybersecurity and cybercrime bill on 4 February 2026, having said in January that consultations would open on 2 February (consultations). The ministry's strategic plan for 2025 to 2030 was launched at Opuwo in January 2026 rather than in the capital (launch). The formal parliamentary route is the ministry's annual budget motivation, which sets out its digital agenda for the year (motivation). The base holds one published consultation record, from December 2022 on the data protection drafts. No submission count, consultation report or response document is held for any of the 2026 rounds. 2026-08-30 — the dominant operator publicly rejected customer claims that it takes data, attributing rapid depletion to streaming and hotspot sharing, and said it is building a control letting customers opt in or out of airtime being spent on data once a bundle runs out, with no implementation date given (discussion). It is the one item here where the public argument is with a company rather than a ministry, and it produced a stated product change where the ministry consultations produced no published response.	MOVEMENT

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	A universal service levy of up to 0.5 per cent of turnover has been in force since 2024, and the Universal Service Fund has awarded nine sites, while the regulator turned a surplus into a loss. The levy is not to exceed 0.5 per cent of annual turnover per licensee with a flat N\$500 floor for non-profit licensees, invoiced on audited statements and payable within thirty days into the fund (regulations); an amendment let the fund receive donations or grants, which is what makes government funding receivable (regulations, withdrawal). A gap analysis identifies 119 locations that will remain unserved after coverage obligations, of which government funding covers the capital cost of 42 (analysis). The fund launched in March 2025 and a first bidding round awarded nine sites with almost N\$31 million of capital subsidy across the five regions where 4G coverage is below 80 per cent, with free internet for schools and clinics on those sites for seven years (fund, priority, report). The government commitment is given as N\$115,000,000 in the regulator's own report and N\$145,000,000 in the launch reporting, and the two are not reconciled (launch). The regulator's revenue fell 23 per cent to 15.5 per cent below budget while operating expenditure rose 42 per cent, turning a N\$32.8 million surplus into a N\$25.5 million loss (accounts, prior year).	MIXED a universal service levy in force and a fund disbursing while the fund's own seed figure is unreconciled and the regulator ran a loss
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	Three memoranda in fifteen months: a five-year United Nations partnership with the largest operator, a tripartite cable agreement, and a regulator-business one. Eleven United Nations entities and the largest mobile operator signed a five-year partnership in May 2025 to accelerate digital inclusion; no commitment figure is stated (partnership). The state fixed operator, its Angolan counterpart and a satellite and cable company signed a master service agreement in June 2026 for the regional submarine system, integrating the existing subsea cable (agreement). The communications regulator and the chamber of commerce signed a three-year memorandum in July 2026 (memorandum), and the regulator holds separate memoranda with the statistics agency and a regional electricity distributor. Only the cable agreement carries a deliverable on this base — an initial dedicated 1.0 Tbps. The rest are frameworks.	MOVEMENT
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	A commercial bank extended a seven-year N\$405 million social loan to the state fixed operator in March 2026, the largest private transaction on the base. The loan funds the operator's five-year infrastructure modernisation and broadband expansion (loan). The private mobile operator invested N\$600,000,000 in its network in the year to September 2025 (network), and the incumbent committed N\$624.9 million to telecommunications infrastructure (incumbent). The earlier private commitment was in international connectivity: roughly US\$5 million co-landing the subsea cable, on the state operator's own account (co-landing). A mining foundation inaugurated a digital technology hub at Ondangwa in June 2026; the account reports the opening of an upgraded facility and states no capital commitment, so no deal record was built (hub).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Development-partner project financing	An indicative N\$5.62 billion programme would fund an artificial-intelligence institute and a national data centre; China committed about N\$245 million to a smart city pilot (grant). The African Development Bank-backed programme would modernise vocational institutions, establish a national artificial-intelligence institute and a national data centre, and create workplace opportunities for 15,000 people (programme). No agreement, disbursement or start date is held. The World Bank's governing framework for FY25 to FY29 sets up to US\$400 million of lending and up to US\$200 million of potential corporation financing, with no digital allocation stated inside it (framework). China committed CNY 98 million, about US\$14.4 million, to the capital's smart city pilot and an artificial-intelligence-ready national data centre (grant). Three institutions are financing a national artificial-intelligence institute and a national data centre that do not yet exist. Neither has a site, a budget line or a date.	MOVEMENT

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	4G population coverage was 88.4 per cent on 2023 data, commercial 5G is live in three centres, and operators have been instructed to retire 2G and 3G. The regulator's series gives 4G population coverage of 85 per cent in 2022, with six of fourteen regions below 80 per cent and one at 41 per cent, 456 of 1,380 schools and 84 of 452 health facilities without 4G coverage, and about 2,000,000 of 2,900,000 mobile cards actively used for internet (2022); the 2023 edition gives coverage of 88.4 per cent, fibre to the home at 27 per cent of fixed broadband subscribers and a 6 per cent fall in active cards (2023, release). The published series is irregular and no edition reporting 2024 data is held (series). Commercial 5G launched at the end of August 2025 in three centres, with nationwide deployment stated as phased and city-first (5G). The regulator has instructed operators to retire 2G and 3G and refarm the spectrum; the incumbent asked government to subsidise smartphones before switch-off, and no switch-off date or government response is on file (retirement).	MIXED 5G live in three centres and 2G and 3G ordered retired while the regulator's own published series stops at 2023
Connectivity	Internet usage	Internet penetration was 62.2 per cent at January 2024, and the share of subscriber modules used for internet rose from 61 to 63 per cent in the third quarter of 2025. The ICT ministry's budget motivation puts penetration at 62.2 per cent and about 1.63 million users at January 2024, with 4G population coverage at 88.4 per cent against 85 per cent in 2022 – 98 and 99 per cent in the strongest urban regions against 49 per cent in Kunene (motivation). In the third quarter of 2025 active modules rose 3 per cent, mobile broadband usage 6 per cent and dongle and router subscriptions 30 per cent, while fixed-line internet subscriptions fell 2 per cent (quarterly). The universal service fund awarded the state fixed operator N\$9,796,650 in April 2026 to deploy infrastructure at sites in underserved rural areas (fund). Rural households remain the gap: 16.2 per cent had mobile internet at November 2025 (rural).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	The regulator's chief executive proposed tax relief on fourth-generation devices, against operator-reported tower utilisation close to half in one region. The proposal was made at a tower launch in Kunene; no fiscal instrument, budget line or ministerial response has been published, and the operator reported utilisation close to 50 per cent across about 74 enabled towers in the region (proposal). Device cost, not coverage, is what the proposal treats as the constraint, and the incumbent made the same argument a year later in asking for smartphone subsidies before the 2G and 3G switch-off.	NO CHANGE a regulator proposal with no fiscal instrument or ministerial response behind it
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The backbone runs to 18,719.5 km, and the state operator is laying redundant long-distance routes after network failures. The ministry's budget motivation gives the network length as 18,719.5 km, longest in //Karas at 3,340.48 km, Otjozondjupa at 2,624.34 km and Erongo at 2,547.72 km (motivation). The state fixed operator said in May 2026 that it is laying new long-distance routes and creating redundant paths between key cities and regions, acknowledging network problems customers had experienced (modernisation), and signed a second open-access fibre partnership in June 2026, live in five named localities (partnership). That modernisation is financed by a seven-year N\$405 million social loan from a commercial bank (loan). No later backbone length is published, so the redundancy work cannot be read as added kilometres.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A subsea cable station at Swakopmund carries a 100G link to Johannesburg, and a 2026 agreement commits an initial 1.0 Tbps on a regional system. The state fixed operator inaugurated its cable station and activated a 100G link between Swakopmund and Johannesburg in July 2024 (station). In June 2026 it signed a master service agreement with two Angolan counterparts for a regional submarine system integrating the existing cable, committing an initial dedicated 1.0 Tbps (agreement); the Namibian operator is the landing party hosting Angolan equipment. A low earth orbit satellite broadband service launched commercially in June 2026 through a licensed local partner, a second international route (satellite). No lit capacity, utilisation or wholesale price figure is published, so the 1.0 Tbps cannot be read against what is actually carried.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	The presidency's own readiness assessment treats exchange points as a precondition and recorded no national data centre in 2022. No later exchange-point figure is published. The government's readiness assessment is the base's only document reaching this question. The presidency's task force recorded that the country had no national data centre in 2022, recommended one be established, and treats digital infrastructure including internet exchange points as a precondition of the transition it assesses. The capture reaches the executive summary of about 190 pages, and the sections naming the exchange point's membership and its ageing equipment were not reached. Nothing published since gives a member count, a traffic figure or a second exchange. The regulator's coverage and subscriber statistics and its integrated annual report carry neither.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	A satellite licence application was declined and 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed, under a 51 per cent Namibian ownership requirement the applicant cannot meet. Licence and spectrum were declined in March 2026 on three of six statutory criteria; 622 of 624 reconsideration requests failed the legal threshold, two were refused on merits, and the operator's own request was dismissed as out of time (dismissal, rejection, block). The ownership requirement is in force with no exemption granted; the regulator held that wholly foreign ownership raises questions of jurisdiction, enforceability of compliance obligations and effective oversight, and states the power to waive the rule rests with the minister rather than with it (requirement). The applicant stated its global shareholding rules bar it from accepting local ownership (exemption).	REGRESSED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	Two commercial data centres are named as established, one operator-run and one run by an aerospace company with a national university. No capacity, load or customer figures are held for either facility (facilities). They are the whole of the country's operating data-centre estate on this record, and the case for hosting compute in the country rests on the subsea landing rather than on installed capacity.	NO CHANGE two commercial facilities named with no capacity, load or customer figure for either
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	A national public data centre is at concept-note stage, while a vendor-built facility for artificial-intelligence workloads is being built on a Chinese commitment. Cabinet directed a concept note and project proposal to the ministry and the Office of the Prime Minister in September 2025, and no site, capacity, cost or date was published by August 2026; the minister said in June 2026 that Angola's national facility had encouraged the plan (concept, proposal, encouragement). A vendor is building smart-city solutions and a data centre with the ICT and home affairs ministries, on a Chinese commitment of CNY 98,000,000 given by the source as about US\$14.4m (funding); no signed agreement, annexure or contractor list is held, and an opposition member gives the same commitment as N\$245m (funding, talks).	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	No government off-site backup exists. A national data centre is funded as a 2026/27 flagship, and one operator sells backup and recovery commercially. The 2022 task force report found the country had no national data centre and recommended establishing one (report). Four years on it is one of the ICT ministry's flagship projects for 2026/27 inside a N\$639.2 million budget, with no site, capacity, cost or completion date published (budget). Commercially, an operator advertises backup and disaster recovery as a service with replication into its own data centre, drawing the distinction between holding a copy and being able to resume operations (service). Two commercial facilities operate, one run by an operator and one by an aerospace company. What is not on the base is any statement of where government data is backed up, or whether it is.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	A N\$394 million digital substation now supplies the coastal corridor including a bulk water scheme, and the first utility-scale battery was commissioned in March 2026. The substation outside Swakopmund became the main transmission supply point for the coastal network, feeding two existing substations, a bulk water scheme serving a uranium mine and a regional medium-voltage network; the utility describes it as the first digital substation in Africa (substation). The utility commissioned the country's first utility-scale battery energy storage system, 54 MW near Otjiwarongo (battery). The ICT ministry's strategic plan makes a green, renewable-powered national data centre a priority under its infrastructure pillar (plan). The base holds a power supply plan for the data centre as Not held, and the data centre itself has no site – so sufficiency cannot yet be tested against a load.	MOVEMENT
Energy	Grid reliability	Transmission system availability held at 99.81 per cent in 2024/25 against 99.80 the year before, with no load-shedding or outages. The utility's integrated annual report puts transmission system performance at 99.81 per cent for 2024/25 against 99.80 per cent the year before, with no load-shedding or power outages, N\$3.9 billion committed to generation and transmission projects and 4,856 GWh into the system of which 44.6 per cent was generated locally (report). Diversification is the direction of travel: the two national utilities signed joint development and power purchase agreements for an interconnector with Angola in April 2026, with no capacity, cost or commissioning date (interconnection). A digital substation and the first utility-scale battery both strengthen the network within the year. More than half the units in the system are imported, which is the exposure the interconnector both answers and deepens.	NO CHANGE
Energy	Rural electrification	A national energy compact targets a 70 per cent electrification rate by 2030 against 59.5 per cent in 2023, with a digitalisation pillar for distributors. The compact commits the government to raise the national electricity access rate from 59.5 per cent in 2023 to 70 per cent by 2030 and clean-cooking access to 61 per cent, through 210,000 new household connections and coordinated grid and off-grid expansion (compact). It also commits distributors to grid intelligence - supervisory control systems, smart metering and automated outage management - and names underuse of digital tools as a current weakness, while carrying no budget line for the digital work itself and no data-centre or large-load category anywhere in its tariff or connection sections (compact). Urban and rural electrification rates are stated as widely different, with most rural households still lighting by candles, batteries and firewood, and no rural rate is given as a number (compact).	NO CHANGE a first position on this indicator with nothing earlier behind it
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	Cabinet approved a government-sector incident response team and security operations centres and a cyber-skills programme for government technology staff, neither established. The team was approved as the central authority coordinating incidents across government, with the Office of the Prime Minister directed to coordinate phased implementation; no establishment, budget or timetable is reported (team). Targeted training in cyber hygiene, incident response and threat intelligence was approved alongside it, with no delivery, budget or cohort reported nine months later (training).	MOVEMENT approved not established

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	The Prime Minister's Office IT division does systems development and maintenance in house, and a 2026 memorandum brings in cybersecurity training for public servants. The division's own service charter states its functions as systems development, infrastructure and maintenance carried out three times a year (charter); no establishment size, vacancy rate or skills figure is held. The public administration institute signed a three-year memorandum with a global cybersecurity centre in June 2026 to train public servants, extending to private-sector professionals, with no funding, cohort size or delivery date published (memorandum). Where systems are built they are procured: the justice and labour ministry tendered in October 2025 for consultancy to develop an integrated employment information system (tender). The same institute announced in May 2026 three- to five-day courses teaching civil servants to use artificial intelligence, and Cabinet approved targeted cyber-hygiene training for government technology staff.	MOVEMENT
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The national incident response team completed its three-year plan and publishes an annual landscape report, while detected vulnerabilities rose 39.8 per cent in a quarter. Namibia launched DigiNam, its national public key infrastructure, with the communications regulator as root certification authority (launch), and the root authority is now live at the top of the country's digital trust chain (report). The team operates under the regulator, was officially launched in April 2025, completed Phase 3 of its implementation plan in the 2025/26 year, and joined three international and regional bodies during 2025; about US\$1m is allocated to cybersecurity for 2026/27 (team, surge, growth). 2026-09-03 - the trust chain acquired its first link below the root: the regulator accredited the home affairs, immigration, safety and security ministry as the country's first certification service provider, on a four-year accreditation announced in Windhoek on 1 September following the key-signing ceremony of 28 August. The state is thus both the root authority's regulator and the first provider beneath it, and no second provider is on the record.	MOVEMENT

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The exchange layer has a name and an owner: Nam-X, built on an Estonian platform and run from the Office of the Prime Minister, in service since 2014 with two further services delivered by March 2025. Nam-X was introduced in 2014 by an Estonian technology firm and e-governance academy, connects the databases of different public bodies, and is the customer system of the Office of the Prime Minister's public-service e-government department; capacity-building projects in 2021-22 and 2023 updated the interoperability framework document and onboarded member organisations (platform). A partner project to build two digital services on it ran from June 2024 and closed on 30 March 2025 at a budget of EUR 99,984 (project). The service bus reported in 2020 and the inter-ministry platform named in 2025 are still not established as the same system, and no operating statistic - services carried, agencies connected, exchanges made - is published for any of them (bus, platform). A memorandum between the revenue agency and the business registry commits the two to share information, with an integrated system named only as a long-term goal (memorandum).	NO CHANGE the platform is now named and located and still carries no published operational statement
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	The population register is operationally integrated with social protection for beneficiary verification, and the first government-to-person payment ran in June 2026. The chief registrar reports the population registration system integrated with social protection for verification of identity and live status, and for identifying and referring undocumented people; over 21,000 San people were assisted under civil registration in 2025 (presentation). The ministry's own earlier annual report documents the electronic birth management system and the population register connected across its offices and border posts (report). The electronic identity pilot at Otjimbingwe was designed to extend digital identity into banking, social grants and online government transactions (pilot). An integrated beneficiary registry is in use and linked to the population register. What is used across systems today is a number and a verification check, not a credential – the electronic identity card itself launches in September 2026.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	A ten-year digital health policy launched in February 2026, and the health minister concedes health and civil registration systems have operated in silos. The ministry launched the National Digital Health Policy for 2026 to 2036 in February 2026 as a ten-year framework, alongside an invitation to procure an electronic health system (launch). The minister states that health and civil registration systems have often operated in silos and that paper-based records and uneven access remain major barriers (fragmentation), which is the position the 2021 e-health strategy set out to change (strategy). A digital community system is replacing paper-based community-health records with an offline-capable tool, with officers trained in July 2026 (training). The e-health network reaches every hospital and 23 health centres, and cause-of-death certification stood at 70 per cent in 2024/25 (budget speech).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	The education management information system gained verification and online-examination features in 2025, and an interface architecture is set out for pushing results back into it. The ministry runs the system as a standing division collecting school data, with the annual education census published to the 2023 edition (system). Its examinations module was extended in 2025 with verification, case management and online examination features (highlights), and a ministry co-authored conference paper sets out an interface architecture for pushing examination data back into the management information system (paper). The education ministry launched a norms and standards framework for schools in August 2026, and a learning passport with a United Nations agency. The architecture is described and no live integration is stated. Nothing on this base connects the education system to any register outside education.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	Grant beneficiaries are now cross-checked against the population register — 15,825 old-age grants were suspended in June 2026 — and the first grant payments ran over the instant payment network. The 2021 social protection policy commits to an integrated management information system linked to the national population register (policy). Two ministries cross-checked grant beneficiaries against the population registration system and suspended 15,825 old-age grants whose holders could not be verified (suspension). The first live government-to-person grant payments ran over the national instant payment network on 17 June 2026 through one certified bank (payment). An integrated beneficiary registry is in use and linked to the register. The interoperability is real, and its first published effect was that number of people losing a payment (suspension); no figure for how many were subsequently restored is held.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	A chipped electronic identity card with a ten-year validity is confirmed for September 2026, carrying a randomly generated number for first-time applicants. The card holds biometric and biographical data plus a digital identity component for remote authentication, with a thumbprint, a facial image and a personal identification number issued as on a bank card, and is valid for ten years against the indefinite lifespan of the document it replaces; a July 2026 launch was announced and slipped, cabinet approved the card in 2023, and none had been issued by August 2026 (card, announcement, validity). Identity numbers had been derived from date of birth; first-time applicants will get a random number, with legacy numbers retained on the reverse of the card and existing documents valid until withdrawn by gazette notice (number, account). The register is already load-bearing for payments, and it failed in June 2026: 15,825 old-age grants were suspended because the beneficiaries' names could not be verified against the national population registry, and pensioners were turned away at pay points before the ministry stated that those affected had either missed the notice or were dead (suspensions).	MOVEMENT slipped

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	117,175 identity documents were issued in 2025, and 40,238 of 166,237 printed were left uncollected over fifteen months. The minister gave 117,175 national identity documents, 126,737 birth certificates and 682 refugee cards issued in 2025 (issuance); the 2024 comparator held in the base is a campaign count rather than an annual series (issuance, budget). Between April 2025 and June 2026, 166,237 documents were printed, 125,999 collected and 40,238 left uncollected, about a quarter of the print run (uncollected). A school-based drive reached 24 of 55 target schools by July 2026, with officials returning to each school to hand printed documents to learners rather than requiring a ministry visit; documentary requirements are unchanged, which the source names as the residual barrier for learners with incomplete birth registration (drive).	MIXED a school-based registration drive running while about a quarter of printed documents go uncollected
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	The electronic identity is free at the point of issue for first-time applicants, renewals, amendments and error replacements, with a first duplicate at N\$150. A first duplicate costs N\$150 and a second N\$300 (fees); the schedule was stated by ministry officials at Gobabis and on a regional awareness tour (fees, expiry). Free issue with a charge only for duplicates is the arrangement most likely to move the uncollected-document figure, and no fee for the card's digital component is separately stated.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	A biometric fingerprint system underpins identity checks, and a chipped electronic identity card with remote authentication launches in September 2026. The home affairs ministry's own annual report describes the operational biometric fingerprint system and the electronic birth management system connectivity that underpin identity verification (report). The minister confirmed in Parliament a September 2026 rollout of electronic identity cards, following delays to finalise legislation on data protection and identity management (confirmation). A pilot ran at Otjimbingwe from September 2025 and a public awareness campaign explaining the consent-based authentication model opened in Omaheke in August 2026 (campaign). The card is free at the point of issue for first-time applicants and carries a digital identity component for remote authentication. The legislation the launch waited on is still not enacted.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	A unique identity number is created for every child notified at birth, and electronic notification now runs across 153 facilities. The population registration system creates a unique identity number for every child notified at birth, from the electronic birth-notification rollout of 2016 to 2018 onward (case study). Electronic birth and death notification operate across 153 facilities on the home affairs minister's account, with birth-registration coverage put near 99 per cent (coverage). Staff were deployed to 24 state hospitals in December 2025 to issue certificates immediately after delivery (hospitals). A mobile identity prototype was tested so a remote mother could register a newborn by phone with a digital signature (prototype). 126,737 birth certificates were issued in calendar 2025 (documents). What is issued at birth is a number and a certificate; the credential comes later, and from September 2026.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	Birth, identity, marriage and death modules were staged into one person profile against the unique identity number between 2012 and 2014. The case study traces the staged integration of the birth, identity, marriage and death modules into a single person profile in the population registration system, keyed to the unique identity number assigned at birth notification (case study). Electronic notification reached 126 facilities by December 2025 and 153 by March 2026, which is the pipe that carries a birth into that profile (facilities). The electronic identity card launching in September 2026 is the credential that would sit on top of it (launch). Namibia's birth-to-identity chain is the most complete on this base among its neighbours, and the thing it has never had is a data protection statute governing what flows along it.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	The population register is read by social protection for beneficiary verification and by the payment network for the first government grant disbursements. The home affairs ministry's annual report documents the register connected across its own offices and border posts (report). Outside the ministry, social protection verifies identity and live status against it, and uses it to identify and refer undocumented people (integration); the effect showed in June 2026 when 15,825 unverified old-age grants were suspended (suspension). The first live government grant payments ran over the national instant payment network in June 2026 through one certified bank (payment). Two systems read the register today: social protection and, through it, payments. No banking, tax or land system is recorded doing so.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The Payment System Management Act 14 of 2023 is in force, licensing is moving to the central bank, and a vision to 2030 succeeds a strategy that closed at 87 per cent implementation. The Act commenced in August 2023 and the payments association moved from a management council to a management board under it during 2025 (Act, board). Licensing and supervision of payment providers are to move to the central bank, with the association given independent governance and its own funding model; no instrument, commencement date or transition plan is published for the transfer (transfer). Licensing itself already sits with the bank: a determination on the licensing and authorisation of payment service providers took effect on 15 February 2024, setting governance, capital, risk and consumer-protection requirements for bank and non-bank providers alike (determination). The bank went to tender in November 2025 for a reconciliation and attestation tool for the instant payment operator, with no award on record (tender). The 2021-2025 strategy closed at an 87 per cent average implementation rate over five years (strategy), succeeded by a vision to 2030 whose next phase is in drafting on interoperable instant payments, the quick-response standard, open banking and cyber resilience (vision).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	The first live government-to-person payments ran on 17 June 2026 to marginalised-beneficiary grant recipients, through one certified bank. The first live government-to-person payments were made on 17 June 2026 to beneficiaries in the marginalised category, facilitated by one of the first banks certified under the instant payment programme (payments). Government social grants are phase one of the platform's rollout; the operator is a subsidiary of the central bank working with an Indian payments partner, runs strictly as a payment system operator and does not serve consumers directly, and the central bank's stated plan is to withdraw from operations and hand the platform to the industry once its public-interest goals are met (fact sheet). Biometric arrangements for the system were being weighed a year before it went live (biometrics). No grant volume, beneficiary count or disbursed value through the platform is published, so the base records the channel and not what has passed through it (launch).	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	The revenue agency collected N\$98.9 billion gross in 2024/25 from 1.0 million registered taxpayers, 575,136 of them electronic filers. At 31 March 2025 the agency had 1.0 million registered taxpayers, of whom 575,136 were registered as electronic filers, on 1.04 million active tax accounts (annual report). Gross revenue that year was N\$98.9 billion and net N\$88.555 billion (annual report). The year before it recorded 477,164 electronic filers (2023/24). A trader identification number became mandatory on every import and export declaration on the customs platform from 1 April 2026, tying the customs register to the taxpayer register (notice). A tax amnesty had brought in 28,157 taxpayers and N\$2.6 billion by 30 September 2025 (amnesty). The integrated tax administration system is in service, and electronic filing covers rather more than half of those registered.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	Open banking specifications are complete, with implementation named a priority under the payments vision and no date published. The specifications were reported completed in July 2026 through the payments association's annual report, which is not itself held (specifications). No participating institution, interface standard or pilot is named. Completed specifications with no implementation date are the same shape as the quick-response standard beside them.	NO CHANGE specifications complete with no implementation date published
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	An Instant Payment Solution went live in June 2026 with three participating institutions, a declaration of intent was signed on clearing integration, and a quick-response standard is finalised. The solution became operational in June 2026 after a live pilot, with a phased national rollout; the go-live month is stated by the central bank and no day is given (launch, build). It is carried publicly as WayaMe, operated by Instant Payments Namibia under the central bank, customers transacting through their existing bank applications, wallets or USSD while the payment is routed through the national infrastructure, and it is designed to carry bank-to-bank, bank-to-wallet, wallet-to-bank and wallet-to-wallet payments (name). No participant list, volume, value or fee schedule is published. A declaration of intent was signed by the central bank, the instant payments company and the clearing house to integrate instant payments with the national clearing infrastructure through the interbank settlement system, with no deliverables, funding or timetable published (declaration). The national quick-response payment standard is finalised with operationalisation named a priority and no live deployment reported (standard).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Financial inclusion is put at 86 per cent for 2025, with an earlier 78 per cent figure dated to 2017 in one account and described as current in another. The deputy governor gave 86 per cent at the payments association's annual general meeting, with the 78 per cent figure dated to 2017 (rate). An industry executive had described the same 78 per cent as current in July 2025 (executive). The two accounts date the same figure eight years apart, which is why the direction here is recorded and the size of the gain is not.	MOVEMENT dating unreconciled
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	The national clearing house signed to join the regional instant cross-border scheme in March 2026 and card e-commerce acceptance opened in August. The clearing house agreed with the regional scheme operator to connect local banks and authorised non-banks to the southern African immediate-clearing network, acting as technical gateway for single credit push payments to Common Monetary Area countries; settlement remains deferred, and fraud management, sanctions screening, request-to-pay and bulk real-time payments are named as later phases with no dates (scheme). Online acceptance of an international card scheme opened to participating merchants, settling in local currency, dollars or both, as part of an extension to nine African markets; no country-specific merchant count is given (acceptance). No record of participation in the continental payment and settlement system exists at August 2026, two years after a regional bank targeted central bank sign-up (system).	MOVEMENT on two channels while participation in the continental settlement system stays unrecorded
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	A determination on fees and charges for payment services took effect on gazetting in December 2025, against banking fraud losses of N\$73.9m in 2025. The determination on standards for fees and charges for payment services was issued under section 45 of the payment system statute and took effect on publication in the gazette on 24 December 2025 (determination). Losses ran at about N\$8.7m a year in 2020 on the central bank's figure and reached N\$73.9m for 2025, with N\$65m lost between January and October; no 2026 figure is held. An inaugural fraud and cybersecurity summit was convened by the ICT ministry with the central bank, the bankers' association, the incident response team and an industry cyber council, and no second edition has been reported (summit).	MIXED a fee and charge standard was gazetted while banking fraud losses rose sharply
Registries	Population register	The national population registration system has been operating since at least 2020 and is the register the September 2026 card is built on. A 2021 baseline found obsolete software, siloed databases and little interoperability; the system now operates with remote biometric enrolment tested through hand-held devices (system, case study). No enrolment count, coverage share or performance figure is published for it, so the register underneath the country's identity programme is described and not measured.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Civil register	The civil registration department had N\$178,122,000 for 2025/26 and no 2026/27 allocation is on file. A separate N\$70m was allocated to the digital identity within a N\$7.4bn ministry budget (allocation). No 2026/27 civil-registration allocation is on file (budget), which matters in the year the electronic card is to be issued and the school-based registration drive is running.	NO CHANGE no 2026/27 allocation published against the previous year's N\$178.1m

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Address register	No address register exists. The postal code system covers sorting and delivery only, and a national addressing system is named as a memorandum objective. The postal operator regrouped its codes from postal administrative regions into political regions, changing the numbering for some towns, and states that this phase covers postal sorting and delivery only and not administrative or geographic addressing, with a physical-address phase still to come (codes). The communications regulator's chief executive named development of a national addressing system as an objective of an April 2026 memorandum with the statistics agency on data sharing and spatial information management (memorandum); no specification, budget or date follows it. The National Digital Strategy launched in August 2025 is the enabling framework (strategy). An addressing system is named in a memorandum and absent from every instrument that could fund or mandate it.	NO CHANGE a postal code system that says it is not an address register
Registries	Business register	A Corporate Laws Bill at third draft would require every company to keep a beneficial-owner register in Namibia, above existing online registration services. The draft consolidates and re-enacts the Companies Act with the business and intellectual property authority as registrar, and its clause 114 would require every company, and every external company establishing a place of business in the country, to keep a register of beneficial owners recording each owner's name, date of birth, identity-document number and residential, business, email and postal addresses; company process is routed through the electronic transactions statute (bill). Online name search, name reservation and application-status verification are already offered, with no transaction or uptake figure published (services).	MOVEMENT
Registries	Social protection register	An integrated beneficiary registry and social assistance system has run since 2022, and 15,825 old-age grants were suspended in June 2026 over unverified names. The registry and the social assistance system were built under the second national prosperity plan, launched in March 2022 and piloted to June 2022 at a cost of N\$4.63 million, with memoranda to exchange data with the pension fund, the social security commission, the tax administration system, the financial management system and the veterans system. At the May 2026 payment cycle 15,825 old-age grants were suspended because the names could not be verified against the national population registry; pensioners were turned away at pay points and told to bring an identity document and birth certificate to a regional office for reinstatement in the next cycle, with back payment promised. The ministry states beneficiaries must verify twice a year with a month's grace, and that it is planning to link its system to the home affairs ministry's for better death reporting (suspensions). No figure for reinstatements, nor any count of beneficiaries on the register, is published.	REGRESSED the register is in use and 15,825 pensioners were cut off by a verification it failed to reach them about

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Electoral register	General registration closed on 1 August 2024 with 1,467,604 voters enrolled, 91 per cent of those eligible, against 1,358,468 in 2019. The general registration period for the 2024 presidential and National Assembly elections closed on 1 August 2024 with 1,467,604 voters registered in-country and at diplomatic missions, about 91 per cent of the roughly 1.6 million the statistics agency put as eligible. Of these, 763,700 men and 852,100 women registered, two regions reached 97 per cent and the lowest region 83 per cent. The 2019 register held 1,358,468 voters, of whom 820,227 voted. The commission publishes supplementary registration and party-registration procedure, including a requirement that a party produce 500 declarations from names on the national register (procedure). No statement of how the roll is deduplicated against the population register, and no post-2024 roll size, is held.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Tax register	The register reached 1.0 million taxpayers by March 2025 and a trader identification number became mandatory on every customs declaration from April 2026. 1.0 million taxpayers were registered at 31 March 2025, of whom 575,136 were electronic filers, on 1.04 million active accounts (report); the year before the agency recorded 477,164 electronic filers (2023/24). From 1 April 2026 a trader identification number is required on every import and export declaration, joining the customs register to the taxpayer register (notice). The amnesty programme added 28,157 taxpayers by 30 September 2025 (amnesty). One million registered taxpayers in a population of about three million. Registration is not the constraint on this base; nothing published says how many of the 1.04 million accounts are active in the sense of filing.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Land register	The deeds register runs under a 1937 statute restored by court order, and a Land Bill tabled in September 2025 proposes the largest restructuring of the framework. A government notice of June 2021 restored the Deeds Registries Act of 1937 as the operative law after a High Court order (notice). The agriculture minister tabled a Land Bill in the National Assembly in September 2025, the largest proposed restructuring of the register framework on this base (statement). A gazette of June 2026 exempted qualifying townships and subdivisions from standard lodging periods, an operational change inside the existing regime (gazette). Business and intellectual property registration is offered online with no transaction figure published. Nothing on the base states whether the deeds register itself is digitised.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Health	A National Digital Health Policy 2026-2036 was launched in February 2026, succeeding a strategy whose period expired, and a community health application is in preparation. The ten-year policy was developed by the health ministry with international technical support, naming interoperability across health information systems, service delivery, governance and evidence-based decision-making as the problem it addresses; no funding, implementation plan or target is published, and it is known through a regional office's account rather than the ministry's own (policy). The 2021-2025 strategy's period expired at the end of 2025 and the successor followed five weeks later (strategy, succession). A mobile application for community health workers is in preparation with phased deployment and paper and digital running in parallel, after national training in July 2026; no rollout date is announced (application). Underneath the policy the network is being laid: every hospital and 23 health centres had e-Health network infrastructure installed by 2024/25, five further centres and 18 clinics were operational, and tenders were awarded to extend 18 more centres and 30 clinics; health data collection reached more than 90 clinics beyond district and hospital level (rollout). Medical certification of cause of death completion rose from 45 per cent to 70 per cent over the same cycle, forensic autopsy reporting passed 90 per cent, and mortality coding is moving to the eleventh revision of the international classification (certification).	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Education	An education management information system runs the annual education census, with the 2023 edition the latest published. The system sits in the education ministry's planning and development directorate and publishes an annual education census; editions from 2019 to 2023 are on the ministry's download page, alongside a fifteenth-school-day report for 2024 (system). No statement of what the system holds beyond the census - enrolment records, teacher records, school infrastructure - is published, and no interoperability with the population register or any other government system is on record.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	Grant beneficiaries are verified against the population register, and an integrated beneficiary registry is in use and linked to it. The 2021 social protection policy commits to an integrated management information system linked to the national population register (policy). The registry is in use and linked to the register, and the first published test of that link suspended 15,825 old-age grants in June 2026 for beneficiaries who could not be verified (suspension). The chief registrar reports the integration used for verification of identity and live status and for identifying and referring undocumented people (presentation). Refugee cash assistance through mobile money has no record since February 2025. What the base holds is a verification link, not a case management system.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	A case management system reached the legal aid directorate in September 2025, and N\$494.1 million is voted to extend it to the Master of the High Court. The judiciary's own report for 2019/20 records electronic filing and case management in the superior courts and a magistrates' courts information system as operating (report). A case management system was rolled into the justice ministry's legal aid directorate in September 2025, with the same platform being extended to a new Master of the High Court system (rollout). The justice department's N\$494.1 million vote for 2026/27 funds that digitisation and a planned legal aid self-service portal (budget). No case volume, disposal time or backlog figure from any of the systems is published, so seven years of rollout cannot be read as an effect.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	The integrated tax administration e-portal carries filing, account statements, assessment objections and certificate issuance, with no uptake figure published. The revenue agency's portal offers online return submission, account statements, objection to an assessment, and printing of good-standing and registration certificates, alongside filing guidance and offline software; return due dates are published for each tax head (portal). The agency and the business registry signed a memorandum to share information, with the commissioner describing integration of the tax and customs systems with the registry as a long-term goal and giving no date (memorandum). No registration, filing or uptake figure is published for the portal, and no ministry statement of what proportion of returns arrive through it is held.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	The customs platform was upgraded to version 4.4.1 over 2025 and 2026, adding risk-based clearance lanes. The upgrade added risk-based clearance lanes and revised procedure codes over an implementation period from July 2025 to April 2026 (upgrade). From 1 April 2026 a trader identification number is mandatory on every import and export declaration, tying customs to the taxpayer register (notice). The agency's annual report is the standing account of customs and excise revenue administration (report). Risk-based lanes are the substantive change: they decide which consignments are examined. No clearance-time, examination-rate or declaration-volume figure is published against them.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Land	The land ministry runs six named systems, and an agricultural land rating and taxation system is under development. The ministry's own account names six systems carrying land administration — computer-aided mass appraisal, communal land rights, land information, land tenure and property rights, mineral and industrial resources, and communal land administration — with the institution responsible for each (presentation). The agriculture ministry has begun developing a commercial agricultural land rating and taxation system in two modules, a mass appraisal system and a land tax payment reconciliation module, alongside a resettlement farms administration system carrying 75,599 applications (system). The urban development ministry launched a national informal settlement baseline inside the housing information system, which carries a land use module (baseline). Six systems in one ministry, a seventh being built in another and a housing system in a third. Nothing on the base connects any of them.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The digital government roadmap targets digital identities for at least a quarter of the population by 2026, electronic signatures missed a February 2026 launch, and full digitisation is targeted for 2029/30. The roadmap runs 2024-2026 and no digital-identity coverage figure has been published, with card issuance beginning only in September 2026; the document is known through one outlet's account (roadmap). Accreditation of electronic-signature service providers was under way with nationwide deployment targeted for February 2026; that target passed without a launch on record, and the capability is now described as a component of the September 2026 identity card (signatures, accreditation). Full digitisation of government services is targeted for 2029/30 with no delivery measure published (target), and a N\$13 million roads project control system was commissioned in August 2026 with no public access to its dashboard stated (roads). One service did go live: computerised learner's licence testing and a book-and-pay system launched at one traffic centre on 9 June 2026, with N\$1.2 million spent there and N\$25 million budgeted for 288 testing units across 43 centres by March 2027. The first 450 applicants passed at 14 per cent, which the minister presented as evidence that leaked papers had been removed rather than as a problem.	MIXED a roadmap target of digital identities for a quarter of the population by 2026 against card issuance beginning only in September and electronic signatures that missed their launch

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	The capital adopted a People-Centred Smart City Strategy 2026-2036 in June 2026, with no funding requirement, timetable or institutional owner published. The strategy was adopted by the city council in June 2026 and handed over in partnership with two United Nations bodies; the named projects are commercialisation of the city's own fibre network as the digital backbone and a proposed commuter rail (strategy, reactions). A Chinese contribution to the pilot was acknowledged in July 2026 (contribution), reported as CNY 98m and as N\$245m with no dated conversion between them (concerns); smart-city development had been under discussion since 2025 with no instrument published (discussion).	MOVEMENT
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	A digital job card co-developed with four town councils replaces paper infrastructure records, on a 1992 Archives Act that already covers local-authority filing. The Archives Act of 1992 covers local-authority archives expressly and gives the head of archives authority to inspect and direct local-authority filing and computer and microfilm projects; it is the base's only instrument bearing on how local government keeps records (Act). A digital job card tool co-developed with four town councils replaces paper-based job-card and infrastructure-damage records with a trackable web and mobile workflow (tool); no rollout beyond the four is held. The urban development ministry launched a national informal settlement baseline inside the housing information system, a digital planning foundation for local authorities (baseline). The capital adopted a people-centred smart city strategy in June 2026. Four town councils out of a country is where local records digitisation stands.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	The e-health network reaches every hospital and 23 health centres, five of them and 18 clinics operational for real-time records. The health minister's budget speech reports e-health infrastructure installed at every hospital and 23 health centres, with five centres and 18 clinics already operational for real-time patient records (speech). The ministry launched a ten-year National Digital Health Policy in February 2026 alongside an invitation to procure an electronic health system (policy). A digital community system replaces paper-based community-health records with an offline-capable tool for community health workers, with officers trained for phased rollout in July 2026 (training). Eighteen clinics running real-time records is the figure that matters, and it is the only one published.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	21 of 188 schools in one region have workable connectivity, leaving 55,002 learners without digital teaching tools, against a national figure of 339 schools and 50 health centres lacking adequate connectivity. The regional education directors told the parliamentary ICT committee that 21 of Kavango West's 188 schools have workable connectivity, leaving 55,002 learners without digital teaching tools, and that the neighbouring region's 197 schools serving 86,282 learners are only marginally connected (committee); health officials told the same committee that clinics still struggle with unreliable coverage (committee, schools, clinics). The ministry's national figure of 339 schools and 50 health centres lacking adequate connectivity dates from June 2025 with no later official figure; a research council account records 65.4 per cent of schools connected in 2023, 1,311 of 2,004, on a different basis that is not comparable (national, council).	REGRESSED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	Electronic birth notification runs across 153 facilities, and a mobile prototype lets a remote mother register a newborn by phone. The explanatory memorandum to the Civil Registration and Identification Bill describes the existing population registration system and legislates registration by electronic notice (memorandum). Electronic birth and death notification operate across 153 facilities on the minister's account, up from 126 in December 2025 (coverage). A mobile identity prototype was tested at Otjimbingwe so a remote mother could register a newborn by phone with a digital signature (prototype), and remote biometric enrolment has been tested through hand-held devices. Over 21,000 San people were assisted under civil registration in 2025 (outreach). The registry reaches rural areas through hospitals and outreach rather than through offices.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	The police ICT programme is replacing analogue radio with digital mobile radios; nothing describes a records or case system at station level. The home affairs minister's budget speech reports the police ICT management programme, voted N\$106,564,000, replacing analogue radio with digital mobile radios and continuing system integration (speech). The enabling layer beneath it is connectivity: the regulator launched universal service fund towers at Epinga in November 2025 and Ehomba in January 2026 (towers), adding to a twenty-five-tower programme in service across nine regions. The one police-adjacent system the base names is a surveillance camera rollout in the capital under the China-funded smart city grant, which is urban. Radios are communications, not records. No docket, case or evidence system at station level appears anywhere on this base.	NO CHANGE radios replaced and no station-level system on the base

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	A donor-funded artificial-intelligence citizen support pilot of the central bank and communications regulator has onboarded more than 2,000 regulated entities. The pilot routes consumer complaints about scams and redress through messaging, web chat and voice to the appropriate regulator or financial institution, with local-language support; more than 2,000 regulated entities are onboarded (pilot). In March 2026 ten agencies - the revenue agency, the communications regulator, the financial supervisory authority, the ombudsman, the pension fund, the social security commission, the roads authority and the mines and energy ministry among them - discussed converting it into a shared service, each running its own assistant on common software, hosting and models, with personally identifiable data kept on sovereign servers while domestic data centres build accelerator capacity (session). The sponsoring programme closes in 2030. No procurement, contract, budget line or agency onboarding since March is on record, and the account is the vendor's own.	NO CHANGE a first position on this indicator with nothing earlier behind it
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Cabinet ordered a N\$39.5m artificial-intelligence crop-monitoring contract cancelled in August 2026, weeks after the one-year contract was reported. The contract, in effect from June 2026, was to build a national crop-monitoring system using satellite imagery, geospatial analysis and artificial intelligence to map agricultural land, monitor crop and pasture health and forecast five crops, with software, models and technical expertise transferred to the ministry and officials trained to run it independently (contract). Cabinet ordered it cancelled in the week of 17 August 2026 and the agriculture ministry is weighing action against the official who authorised it; government did not attribute the cancellation to the technology, the value is reported as N\$39.5m and N\$40m in different accounts, and the review itself is not published (cancellation, block, account). The award had drawn public objection over transparency and local participation, and no procurement route or text of the data-ownership terms was published.	REGRESSED
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Namibia took a seat on the ITU's AI for Good Global Commission (announcement). The information and communication technology minister announced on 28 August 2026 that Namibia holds a seat on the ITU's AI for Good Global Commission (announcement). The initiative was launched at a continental telecommunications conference with the ICT ministry a named partner, scaling an existing national model template; the stated commitment is ministerial support rather than a named contribution, and no Namibian funding, dataset or deliverable is published (initiative, declaration, account). A voice-data repository for Namibian indigenous languages is being built through a development programme sprint with the national science and technology university; no language count, corpus size, licence or release date is stated, and who owns the collected speech and on what terms it can train models is not addressed (repository).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Control of AI abuse	Two deepfake incidents drew official responses in late 2025, against an assessment confirming there is no artificial-intelligence regulatory framework. The ICT minister warned in September 2025 against circulating an artificial-intelligence-generated video promoting a fake government investment scheme (warning), and in November the Presidency denounced a viral deepfake audio and video impersonating the President (fact check). No prosecution, takedown or regulatory action followed either on the base. The readiness assessment launched in August 2025 confirms the absence of a formal artificial-intelligence regulatory framework (assessment), and legislation is announced as following the strategy, which is itself under development. The instruments that would bite — a data protection Act and a cybercrime Act — are both still Bills. The state's response to two impersonations of itself was to issue statements.	MOVEMENT
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	The first privately owned mobile network launched in September 2025 on N\$600m of investment, against a dominance determination naming the state operator dominant in all four priority markets. The network is live on long-term evolution and 5G, with N\$600m invested in the preceding year and N\$1.42bn in Namibian network infrastructure since 2018, company-reported (launch, announcement, investment, record). The 2024 determination names the state fixed operator dominant in all four priority markets, alone in wired end-user access and jointly elsewhere, with termination treated as a natural monopoly; the regulator describes its approach across all three exercises as one of minimal intervention (determination).	MOVEMENT
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	A national artificial-intelligence institute recommended by a 2022 task force is proposed and not established, with no site, budget, host or founding instrument on file. The sixth national development plan calls for a research centre and the institute remains proposed (institute). Four years after the recommendation there is no site, budget, host or founding instrument. The working capability the country has instead sits in a university accelerator recorded separately.	NO CHANGE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	Cabinet authorised an information technology venture capital fund at US\$20m and directed engagement with female founders as potential beneficiaries. No fund manager, first close, instrument, Namibian-dollar figure or disbursement is on file eleven months later (fund). The amount is published only in United States dollars, so the row cannot carry the announcing party's own currency, and no count of firms, deals or jobs is held for the country.	NO CHANGE a fund authorised at US\$20m with no manager, close or disbursement on file

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A public-service cyber training partnership was signed in June 2026 for joint training of public servants, extending to private-sector professionals. No funding, cohort size or delivery date is published, and the memorandum text is not held (partnership). It sits beside a cabinet-approved cyber-skills programme for government technology staff that has also not reported a cohort, so the civil service has two approved training routes and no trained count.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	No standalone national digital-literacy strategy or programme exists outside the school curriculum. The Information and Communication subject is the country's whole digital-literacy provision on this record, compulsory and assessable for school pupils and reaching nobody else (curriculum). No adult programme, measurement or target is held. The identity awareness campaign and the youth ambassador programme recorded elsewhere in this ledger are the nearest thing to population-level digital outreach, and both are about one credential. 2026-09-06 - a domestic argument put the language question at the centre of the divide: writing on two children sitting the same national examination, a commentator argues that generative tools supply the polish that growing up with English at home has always supplied silently, so the tools redistribute an advantage rather than create one. It is an opinion piece and the base holds no measurement of examination or tool use by home language to set against it.	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	An Information and Communication syllabus is compulsory and assessable across Grades 4 to 12, and a learning platform launched in August 2026. The subject runs across three themes of digital, media and information literacy; the Grade 12 syllabus was published in 2018 for implementation in 2021 and the Grade 8 and 9 syllabus in December 2024 for phased implementation in 2025 and 2026 (syllabus, senior secondary). A digital and offline learning platform aimed at rural, remote and underserved young people was launched by the education ministry with an international agency; no user target, content catalogue, device requirement or offline distribution route is stated (platform).	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A university artificial-intelligence and robotics accelerator underpins the country's first artificial-intelligence degree, and a five-node computing cluster is specified for a university campus. The accelerator was launched with central bank funding and supports bachelor's and honours degrees in artificial intelligence and a master's in data science; it is known through the research council's authors citing the university's own announcement (accelerator). A five-node high-performance computing cluster is specified for deployment at the science and technology university under a bilateral centre of excellence, with no operator, cost or opening date published; it is a university research cluster and the source itself warns it must not be conflated with a national facility (cluster).	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	The science and technology university added eleven new qualifications in January 2026 including a bachelor's in artificial intelligence. The new qualifications include a bachelor's degree in artificial intelligence and honours degrees in artificial intelligence, data science, information security, human-computer interaction and digital forensics (qualifications). A vendor-led five-year national talent cultivation programme targets 1,000 ICT learners, 50 certified engineers and 200 women engineers (programme, congress). The national instrument behind the pipeline is the training authority's five-year plan, which states that the skills development system as a whole has not yet achieved what was expected of it (plan). A university runs an artificial-intelligence and robotics accelerator, and the country holds three UNESCO chairs, one in secure high-performance computing. No graduate count for any digital qualification is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	Three of the four UNESCO Chairs held in Namibia sit at the science and technology university, one of them in secure high-performance computing. Only four UNESCO Chairs have been established in the country and three are housed at one university, their programmes covering water research for climate adaptation, gender and digital technologies, and secure high-performance computing for higher education and research (chairs). The university also hosts a bilateral centre of excellence in information technology and an earth observation and satellite applications research and training centre (listing). No publication record, funding line or policy output is attached to any of the chairs in the base, so what they contribute to digital policy is not established.	NO CHANGE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	The Ombudsman takes complaints online into an electronic case system, and two regulators launched an artificial-intelligence complaint pilot in December 2025. The Ombudsman's annual report for 2024 records intake by online submission, website form, electronic mail, short message and social media, feeding an electronic case management system (report). The central bank and the communications regulator launched a pilot connecting over 2,000 banking, insurance, non-banking and telecommunications businesses into one multilingual complaint-resolution platform speaking Afrikaans, English, German and Oshiwambo (pilot). The health ministry launched a standard operating procedure for complaints at public health facilities in June 2026 (procedure). A free application takes public reports of infrastructure faults. No complaint volume or resolution rate is published for any of the four channels.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	An electronic identity awareness campaign is running region by region in local languages, with a youth ambassadors programme promoting take-up. The campaign opened in the capital region and its Omaheke leg ran across all seven constituencies in late July and early August 2026, run by home affairs with a development agency and the regulator, with a brand ambassador running sessions in local languages (campaign, conference, preparation). A youth ambassadors programme uses young people to promote take-up and civic participation; participant numbers, cost, duration and any enrolment effect are not stated, and the funding agency's own account is the only source (ambassadors).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Gender equity	The third national gender policy carries a communications theme, and a women in technology initiative launched in May 2026; no gendered access figure is published. The current national gender instrument, approved by Cabinet in October 2023, carries a dedicated thematic area on gender, media, information and communication (policy). A women in technology initiative launched at an industry congress in May 2026 alongside a talent programme targeting 200 women engineers (initiative). A global financial inclusion study catalogued for the country in January 2026 carries sex-disaggregated indicators for mobile phone ownership, internet use and digital financial services from 2024 fieldwork (study); the catalogue entry is held rather than the microdata, so no figure reaches this base. Financial inclusion overall stands at 86 per cent (inclusion). The data to split it by sex exists and is not on the record here.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	A national disability policy committing to accessible ICT came into operation in October 2025, and a sign language app launched in September. The policy for 2025 to 2030 was gazetted by substitution into the Schedule of the National Disability Council Act and came into operation on 14 October 2025, committing to accessible information and communications technology, information and electronic government services (policy). The national association of the deaf launched a sign language learning application for both mobile platforms in September 2025 (application). Of the five national statistics standards issued in September 2025, one is a leave no one behind standard (standards). No accessibility audit of a government service, and no figure for digital access among persons with disabilities, is held. A commitment to accessible electronic government sits against 31 online services. The Vice-President set out new guidelines and digital systems for disability assessment and access to the disability grant, presented as removing barriers and delivering faster and more accountable service. No system name, supplier, timetable, beneficiary count or accessibility standard is stated, and the claims are the government's own.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	682 refugee identity cards were issued in 2025, and cash assistance through mobile money reached about 6,000 people in 2025. Issuance of refugee cards began in June 2024 and 682 were issued in calendar 2025 (cards, system). Cash assistance through mobile money launched in February 2025 for about 6,000 individuals in over 1,000 households, with the agency reporting it held 40 per cent of the resources needed and no record since (assistance).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	Twenty-five towers entered service across nine regions, schools and clinics under new towers get seven years free internet, and 100 per cent coverage is targeted for 2030. Twenty-five towers went into service across nine regions at N\$40m in total, about N\$1.6m each, built with the state fixed operator (towers). Schools and clinics under towers built in the previous two years get free internet for seven years, on N\$80m in nine radio access network towers over two years (free internet); no list or count of covered schools or clinics is published (free internet). The 2030 coverage target was set in June 2025 against about 360,000 people, roughly 12 per cent, outside 4G coverage at February 2024, with a parallel internet-use target of 53 to 90 per cent by 2030 (target, plan). Siting delays on communal land are the constraint the ministry names, and it met the traditional authorities' trust with the regulator and three operators in July 2026 with no agreement reported (siting). A stakeholder submission to the periodic review put internet penetration above 64 per cent in 2025 but rural household mobile internet access at 16.2 per cent and smartphone ownership below 30 per cent, naming affordability and low digital literacy as what holds access back, alongside a persistent gender gap in meaningful use (submission).	MOVEMENT

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	A national strategy for the development of statistics runs 2023/24 to 2026/27 at N\$58,995,000, alongside the agency's own institutional strategic plan. The strategy sets four goals covering better use of statistics for policy, efficient data processes, a better funded national statistics system and improved integration with spatial data, resting on ten first-phase sector plans, at a total implementation cost of N\$58,995,000 over four years (strategy). The agency's separate institutional plan covers 2022/23 to 2026/27 on four focus areas including spatial data coordination and alternative data sources, and records that funding was relatively adequate until about 2016 and that the population census slipped twice for want of funds (plan). The two are distinct documents and should not be merged.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The 2023 population and housing census was the country's first fully digital census and remains the reference count at 3,022,401. It is cited by the statistics agency as a step in modernising the national statistical system (census, awareness). The agency's own institutional plan records that the census slipped from August 2021 and again from August 2022 for want of funds, so the digital operation was delivered two years late and no successor is scheduled on this record.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The producer price index moved off spreadsheets onto an automated engine with revisions back to 2015, and the quarterly bulletin is now held as a primary. Compilation moved to an automated processing engine, disclosed in the second-quarter 2026 bulletin and carrying retrospective revisions of producer price estimates back to 2015: missing prices are now imputed as a turnover-weighted average of observed price relatives within the product group, imputation is capped at three consecutive periods before an item must be replaced, and automated validation flags extreme swings and entry errors (system). The bulletin itself is held in full where the base had carried its figures only as reported, and it carries no digital-sector breakout (bulletin). The country has subscribed to an international data dissemination standard since December 2022, one of about seven African countries (subscription), and held an inaugural statistics awareness day in July 2026 themed on statistics in the digital age (day).	MOVEMENT
Open data	Use of open data	The statistics agency runs data portals and a microdata catalogue of sixteen studies with stated access terms, while a reporting application and an environmental platform publish no dataset. The agency operates a data portals page and a catalogue holding sixteen Namibian studies from 1992 to 2023, each carrying a stated access term; the source states explicitly that this is agency-run dissemination and not a government-wide open data policy or portal, which the base does not hold for the country (catalogue). An infrastructure reporting application launched nationwide takes public reports of more than thirty kinds of fault onto a mapped national dataset with automatic facial and licence-plate redaction; it is privately built and privately held, with no user count, data-sharing arrangement with any authority, or licence for the dataset stated (application). An environmental agreements monitoring platform launched at N\$12m to centralise environmental data for planning and national reporting, with no public access, dataset list, licence or publication rule stated, so it is a reporting tool rather than open data on the record held (platform).	MIXED an agency microdata catalogue with stated access terms against two new platforms that publish nothing
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A satellite data-receiving ground station is in operation, the country's first, and a Space Science and Technology Bill has been approved for drafting with no text published. The station was handed over by China at the earth station outside Windhoek and receives remote-sensing data, operated by fourteen trained Namibians (station, handover). Cabinet approved drafting of a space statute during 2025 and no text or introduction date has been published (bill, approval). The country's one recorded application of satellite data to agriculture, a crop-monitoring contract, was cancelled by cabinet in August 2026.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	Hydrological services run a satellite precipitation product in the daily flood bulletin, and a China-aided ground station was handed over in 2026. The agriculture ministry's hydrological services use a satellite-derived real-time precipitation product in their flood and hydrological drought bulletin (bulletin). A China-aided satellite ground data receiving station at the telecommunications earth station outside the capital was formally handed over in February 2026 (handover), and is in operation as the country's first such facility. A dashboard integrating earth-observation products for crop and drought monitoring is in development, and a space science and technology Bill has been approved for drafting with no text or introduction date published. The station receives; what the meteorological service does with what it receives is not on this base.	MOVEMENT

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A subsea cable landing at Swakopmund has been in service since 2022 and is the only United States technology asset in the country the base carries outside satellite licensing. The landing is cited as the connectivity leg of the case for hosting compute in the country (landing, ownership). No hyperscaler memorandum, region, data centre or commitment is recorded, and the one American satellite operator to apply for a licence was refused. So the relationship is a cable and a refusal.	NO CHANGE
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	China committed CNY 98,000,000 to the capital smart-city pilot, is building a data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads and handed over the country's first satellite ground station. The commitment, about US\$14.4m on the source's conversion, covers digital infrastructure, artificial-intelligence capability and skills under the city's ten-year strategy (commitment); the signature date is padded from a reference to the end of June, and an opposition member gives the same commitment as N\$245m (commitment, talks, record). A vendor is building smart-city solutions and a data centre with two ministries, with no signed agreement, annexure or contractor list held (data centre). The satellite ground station outside the capital was handed over by China and is operated by fourteen trained Namibians (station). An opposition member has raised data-control concerns about the smart-city grant.	MOVEMENT
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	The European indicative programme has no digital priority area, allocating EUR 26,000,000 for 2025-2027 with digitalisation only cross-cutting. The initial 2021-2024 envelope was an indicative EUR 37,000,000, and the mid-term review set the 2025-2027 allocation at EUR 26,000,000: inclusive green growth twenty, good governance and gender equality two, support measures four, and foundational skills education nil (amendment, programme). The named digital offer is support to Parliament's electronic-parliament blueprint, and data protection and cyber security appear once in the programme, qualified as possible.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A bilateral economic commission with technology transfer and skills in its remit was proposed at a business forum in February 2026, with no agreement signed. The commission's proposed remit covers technology transfer, skills development, industrialisation and manufacturing, and the Gulf side raised investment protection and double-taxation agreements; no Gulf-state digital, data-centre or artificial-intelligence agreement is published (proposal). The forum's own trade list runs to diamonds, scrap metal, charcoal, frozen fish and dates, with the ask being value addition before export, which is the context the technology element sits inside.	MOVEMENT proposal only
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	A cyber security memorandum was signed in July 2025 and cooperation was advanced at a joint trade committee in August 2026. The memorandum was signed at State House during a visit, alongside an entrepreneurship centre agreement, and no implementation activity, funding or programme has been reported since (memorandum). Cooperation was advanced at the fourth joint trade committee in New Delhi in August 2026, building on a memorandum signed by the two heads of government in July 2025, with bilateral trade put at more than US\$592m in 2025/26 (committee); the memorandum text is not held and no workstream, funding or timetable is attached (committee). A five-node computing cluster is separately specified for a university campus under a bilateral centre of excellence (cluster).	MOVEMENT

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Consultancy engagement on the artificial-intelligence framework	A procurement award notice, terms of reference or signed advisory agreement; the base carries two accounts of a 2026-08-03 meeting and the minister's statement that the research council leads, and no contract, scope of work, procurement route or value, with none listed on the central procurement board	2026-08-06
National high-performance computing facility	A research council or ministry announcement, procurement notice or budget line for a national compute facility; the base carries the council's own statement that its data committee is to provide such centres and that securing computing infrastructure is a next step, and separately that a vendor is building a data centre for artificial-intelligence workloads, with no named facility, site, capacity, cost or operator	2026-08-06
Start-up act	A gazetted act or a published bill; a held source records that at 2026-08-09 no gazetted or tabled start-up legislation could be located and that the nearest policy instrument, the National Informal Economy, Start-ups and Entrepreneurship Development Policy, is not published at any URL, so what is outstanding is confirmation that none exists rather than a document	2026-08-06
Government interoperability framework	A published interoperability framework, standard or governing instrument; the base names three data-exchange objects across ten years and establishes no relationship between them, no operating body and no governance rules	2026-08-06
Payments association 2025 annual report	The report itself; the base holds two press accounts of its 2026-07-28 release and no primary, and the association's own site publishes only a memorandum and a board release, so four payment rows stand on press reporting of one unheld document	2026-08-06
National open data policy or government portal	A portal address, a dataset catalogue or a policy document; the subject holds nothing for Namibia, and the nearest held material is central bank and statistics agency statements on administrative data, which concern data quality rather than publication	2026-08-06
Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill	A ministry consultation notice, submissions register or committee record; the base carries only two sources on this subject and a researcher's statement that the public had not seen the latest draft at 2025-08-17	2026-08-06

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Smart-city grant agreement and annexures	The signed grant agreement, its annexures, the contractor list and the data architecture; the base carries an opposition member's characterisation and a presidential acknowledgement of the amount, with no instrument text, and does not establish the Chinese disbursing agency	2026-08-06
Ratification of the continental convention on cyber security and personal data protection	The continental depositary list entry or a Namibian instrument of ratification or accession; the base carries 20 sources on this subject, all bilateral or convened by an industry body, and none names a continental or regional data-governance instrument Namibia has acceded to	2026-08-06
National digital literacy programme	A named ministry or regulator digital-literacy strategy, curriculum or programme document; the subject carries exactly one Namibian source, the regulator and chamber memorandum of 2026-07-30, which names digital literacy as a workstream with no funding, deliverable or target	2026-08-06
Information and communications technology ministry budget vote	The ministry's vote in the appropriation bill or its budget-vote motivation speech; the base holds no Namibian technology appropriation of any year, and the one appropriation figure held anywhere in the base is the civil registration department's, on a source tagged to other subjects	2026-08-06
Universal Service Fund annual accounts	The fund's annual report, or the regulator's disclosure of levy receipts and project disbursements; the base establishes the fund exists, its launch month, its initial endowment and two in-kind outputs, all from secondary reporting of ministerial statements, and carries no levy rate, contribution base, receipts or project list	2026-08-06
Power supply plan for the national data centre	A power purchase agreement, grid-connection study or energy annex to the data-centre project proposal; the subject carries one Namibian source, a signed opinion piece arguing the case for hosting compute locally, so there is no held statement of how any planned facility would be powered, at what cost, or by whom	2026-08-06
United States health data and specimen sharing arrangement	A signed data or specimen sharing arrangement with the United States, or a published text of the proposal that was refused.	2026-08-31

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